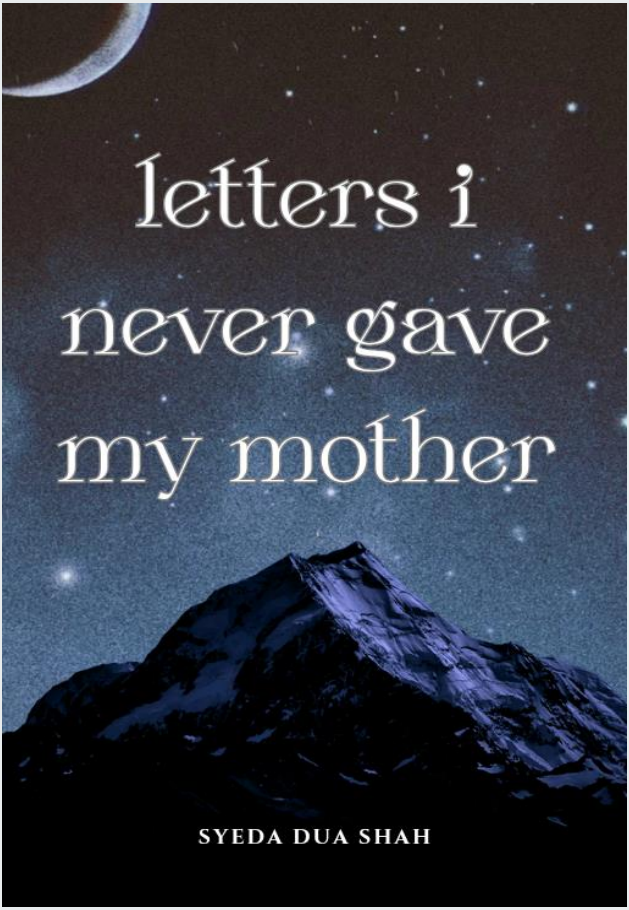

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LETTER "I"

NEVER GAVE

MY MOTHER

WINNING

Without Intimidation

DUA SHAH

Author's Introduction

Syeda Dua Shah is a 17-year-old writer with a deep love for words and emotions. Writing has always been her way of understanding life, expressing feelings, and giving voice to thoughts that often remain unspoken. She writes with honesty and simplicity, making her work relatable to readers of all ages.

As a book writer, article writer, and poet, she believes that words have the power to heal, connect, and comfort hearts. This book is a reflection of her personal journey, written with sincerity and quiet strength...

She writes under the pen name **Shah**.

Dedication

To my **mother**,
who left this world but never left my heart.
These incomplete letters carry your love,
and my strength still begins with you.

Acknowledgements

This book would not have been possible without the quiet strength I found within myself after loss. I am grateful to everyone who stood beside me during moments of silence, offering patience, understanding, and support without words.

I also thank every reader who opens these pages with an open heart. If these letters feel familiar to you, know that you are not alone. This book is as much yours as it is mine.

Most of all, this book exists because of

my mother whose love continues to guide me, even in her absence...

Author’s Preface

This book was never meant to be perfect.
It was meant to be honest.

These pages hold the words I could never say out loud, the letters I never gave to my mother, and the feelings I carried quietly after she left. Some emotions are too deep for conversations, so I chose to write them instead.

Losing a mother changes you in ways no one prepares you for. Life continues, but something inside your pauses. Through these letters, I tried to understand that silence, that absence, and the strength it quietly teaches.

This book is written in simple words, **for readers of all ages** especially those who are still growing, still learning, still healing. You don’t need to have lost someone to understand this book; you only need a heart that feels.

If even one page makes you feel less alone, then these incomplete letters have found their purpose.

Chapter 1

The Day Everything Fell Silent

The moment life changed quietly

Instead, it came quietly, bearing a silence unlike anything I had ever experienced before. Although the morning looked ordinary, something was missing. The house was silent, as if holding its breath. The warmth of my mother's voice, which had filled every corner, was no longer there.

The kitchen felt empty.

The air felt heavy.

All the familiar sounds had disappeared, leaving behind a silence that hurt more than words ever could. I kept asking myself how one moment could change everything. How could life move forward while my heart stayed behind? That day taught me something I never wanted to learn: some losses don't scream; they simply stay and change you forever.

“Mother, I am still alive without you, but only by holding on to your memories.”

A House Filled with Silence

The house felt different without her, didn't it? Every room was filled with a special kind of quiet that I had never noticed before. The living room, once filled with her laughter, now felt cold and empty. The kitchen, where the delicious smell of her cooking always greeted

me, was quiet. Even the smallest things her slippers by the door, her scarf draped over a chair reminded me of her absence, and I could almost feel the spaces she used to fill.

Those sounds we all know and love the ticking clock and the fridge hum suddenly seemed very loud, as if they were echoing in the emptiness. I wandered from room to room, expecting her voice to call my name, but I remembered that she wouldn't. The silence wasn't peaceful; it was heavy, pressing against my chest, making the house feel like a space I didn't belong to anymore.

It was in that quiet moment that I realised ... isn't it strange how it only really hits you when you're in that space? – that a home isn't just about walls and furniture, but the people who make it feels alive.

I know that without her, the house was still standing, but I just don't feel like it's my home anymore...

Chapter 2

The First Day Without My Mother

Waking Up to an Unfamiliar Morning

I woke up that morning feeling a bit strange, as if I had a bit of emptiness inside. The sunlight came streaming into my room, just like any other day, but it didn't bring the usual warmth. Everything around me felt comfortingly familiar, yet at the same time, there was a gentle, reassuring shift, too. The sheets smelled like her, the pillow still carried her scent faintly, but she wasn't there to greet me, to call my name, or to remind me that everything would be alright.

I sat on the edge of the bed, trying to convince myself that it was just another morning, but the truth hit me – this morning, and every morning from now on, would be different. I

had always taken the sounds around me for granted, like the distant hum of the fridge and the creak of the floorboards, but in the quiet they felt too loud. Every corner of the room felt like it was missing her… I got up slowly, feeling the weight of the day ahead. Even walking to the window felt strange; the sunlight didn't feel like a beginning, but a reminder that she wasn't there to share it with me. The world carried on as if nothing had happened, but my heart was still stuck in that moment of sadness. I don't know about you, but I've realised that mornings are more than just the start of something new.

They're also a chance to think about the people we miss and the strength we need to find to get through another day without them.

Learning to Face the Day Alone

The rest of the day stretched out before me, and I felt like I had this long, lonely road to walk by myself. I know we all have those tasks that used to feel ordinary, like making breakfast, tidying the room or even opening the windows to let in fresh air. But I know how it is, those tasks can suddenly feel heavier, as if we were carrying an invisible weight. Every little routine made me think about how she wasn't there to guide me, to laugh with me, or to quietly correct me when

I stumbled... I learned quickly that the world doesn't pause for grief, and that's OK.

People carried on with their day, not a clue about the storm raging on the inside. I had to make myself eat, get dressed, speak when spoken to and smile even when I felt broken inside. Each step felt a bit weird at first,

but I realised that this was just how life was going to go on, whether I was ready for it or not... It was really tough going, but it was also a great lesson in strength. I discovered that even without her by my side, I could take small steps forward. I could make decisions, look after myself, and keep going through the day. I know it wasn't easy, and I'm not going to pretend that it was. But every hour I survived without collapsing felt like a quiet victory, a way of honouring her by living, even in her absence.

By the end of that first day, I had an important realisation: learning to face the day alone didn't mean I was weak. It meant that I was carrying her love, her lessons, and her memory inside me,

and that was enough to keep going one small moment at a time...

Chapter 3

A House that no longer feels like home

Empty Rooms and Quiet Corners

As I walked through the house, I couldn't help but notice how different everything felt without her. Each room seemed to have its own quiet sadness. The living room, where the sunlight used to dance across the floor as she moved about, now sat still and lifeless. The couch she always chose felt a little too big, a little too empty, as if it were waiting for her presence that would never return...

Even the corners of the house, the ones I rarely paid attention to, seemed to echo her absence. The hallway felt longer and darker somehow, and the soft creak of the wooden floorboards no longer felt familiar – it reminded me that the house was hers, and now it wasn't. Every object she had touched, every chair she had arranged, every little detail of her presence seemed frozen in time, waiting for her to come back, but I knew deep down she never would. It was in these empty rooms and quiet corners that I first realised that a home is not just made of walls, furniture, or belongings.

A home is made alive by the people in it – and that's such a beautiful thing!

Chapter 4

The Voice I No Longer Hear

Silence Where comfort once lived

Silence became my constant companion. It followed me everywhere — into rooms, into my thoughts and into moments where her voice once lived. This wasn't a gentle or peaceful silence, though. It was heavy and loud in its own way, and impossible to ignore. It settled deep inside my chest and stayed there.

I never realised how much her voice had shaped my everyday life until it was gone. Her soft reminders, her comforting words and even her quiet reprimands had filled spaces that now felt unbearably empty. The house remained the same, yet without her voice, it no longer felt familiar. There were moments when

I would stop and wait to hear her call my name or ask if I had eaten. I waited for her words to guide me, to comfort me and make things feel normal again. But silence always answered instead, stretching between moments and making time feel slower.

Over time, I came to understand that silence after loss is not the absence of sound. It is the presence of memories of everything that was once said and everything that will never be said again…And within that silence, I realised how deeply her voice still lived inside me. Silence taught me things that her voice could never have explained. It taught me that love isn't defined by sound and that presence isn't defined by presence. Even in silence, her words live on in the way I think, the way I care and the way I keep going.

I learned that silence is not always emptiness; sometimes it is love learning how to endure.

Chapter 5

Questions Without Answers

Living With “Why”

After she left, my life slowly became filled with questions that had no answers. The word 'why' echoed in my mind from morning until night. Why her? Why so suddenly? Why did life choose this pain for us? No matter how many times I , silence was the only answer. That silence felt heavier than any explanation ever could...I searched for meaning in everything. In old memories, in prayers whispered through tears and in conversations that I replayed in my mind again and again. I wondered if I had missed a sign, if I could have done something differently, or if loving harder could have changed the outcome.

These thoughts didn’t bring answers, but they stayed, refusing to leave.

Living with the question of why was exhausting. They made my heart restless and my nights longer. Some days, the questions hurt more than the loss itself. I wanted clarity; I wanted a reason that could soften the pain and make sense of the emptiness she left behind. But grief doesn't work that way — it doesn't explain itself... Gradually, I began to realise that not every loss comes with answers. Some losses are not meant to be understood, only endured. The moment I stopped demanding explanations from life;

I felt a quiet shift inside me. The questions were still there, but they no longer controlled me.

Learning to live with the **'why**' did not mean forgetting her or accepting the loss easily. It meant accepting that love does not always come with closure. Some questions will

always remain unanswered, and that is part of loving deeply. I realised that searching for peace mattered more than searching for reasons...Ultimately, I learned that life does not owe us explanations for every heartbreak. Sometimes, it asks us to carry on living anyway to breathe, to remember, and to move forward with unanswered questions resting gently in our hearts.

Some questions never find answers, but life teaches us to keep living with them, and that, too, is a kind of strength.

Chapter 6

Learning to Breathe Again

Finding Strength in Small Moments

Life did not suddenly become easier after the storm of grief passed. It simply slowed down. The pain did not leave me; it learned to sit quietly beside me. I discovered that healing does not come with clear signs or sudden happiness. Instead, it comes gently, in moments so small that, at first, they feel unimportant. At first, even these moments felt unfamiliar. A morning without tears. A breath that didn't hurt. A short smile that appeared without warning. Each of these moments made me pause, not because they were comforting, but because they made me feel guilty. I felt as if allowing myself to feel okay meant that I was forgetting her. But grief slowly taught me that love does not disappear when pain subsides it simply changes form.

I realised that strength is not always loud or visible. It does not always look like bravery.

Sometimes, strength means choosing to wake up when sleep feels safer. It looks like eating when your heart feels empty and speaking when silence feels easier. It means surviving another day when you're not sure how you managed it… There were days when I felt fragile and days when I felt almost normal. Both were part of the healing process. I learned that feeling better does not erase the past and that feeling weak does not mean you are failing. Healing is not a straight path it moves forward, pauses and sometimes takes a step back. And all of that is progress; Gradually, I began to understand that survival is not a betrayal of love. Living does not mean leaving someone behind. Every small moment of peace that I experienced contained her love within it. Her strength lived on in the way I persevered, even when I lacked self-confidence.

I started to trust life again, one breath at a time. I learned that sadness and hope can

coexist, and that joy does not negate grief. The heart has room for both, even when it feels broken.

If you are grieving, don't rush yourself to heal. Allow yourself to enjoy small moments of peace, free from guilt.

Don't measure your strength by how much you suffer, but by how gently you carry on. Loss may change you, but it does not have to destroy you. Sometimes, the bravest thing you can do is simply breathe, and let that be enough.

Chapter 7

Prayers She Left Behind

Finding Comfort in Her Faith

Even after she had gone, her lessons stayed with me not in grand speeches or written notes, but in the little things she did every day. The way she greeted the morning with patience, treated everyone with kindness and never gave up, even when life felt heavy, silently taught me how to live, love and keep faith, even in moments of despair.

I noticed that her words, though simple, contained a wisdom that I had often overlooked. A gentle reminder to eat, a nudge to be patient and a smile that spoke volumes these were the lessons she left behind. And now, in her absence, I understood their meaning more deeply. They were not just instructions, but lifelines that guided me through the days when I felt lost.

Her actions showed me that strength is quiet and resilience is gentle. She never

shouted, forced or demanded; she simply lived her values, leaving me a blueprint for facing life's challenges. Even in grief, I found guidance in her habits, her graceful demeanour, and the love she brought to every moment. Through her words and actions, I learned that true lessons do not fade with absence. They live on in the way we act, the way we carry ourselves and the way we share love and faith with others. She may no longer be physically present, but her teachings remain, quietly shaping who I am and who I am becoming.

Although she is no longer with us, her teachings continue to guide me every day. Her prayers, words and small actions have become part of who I am. I have learned that love is not diminished by absence and wisdom is not diminished by silence.

The greatest gift she left me is not just memories, but the strength to live with

compassion, patience and faith. I carry her teachings forward quietly in every choice I make and every moment I experience...

Chapter 8

Her Scolding, Now Missed

Love hidden in discipline

It was only when she was gone that I realised how much her scolding had shaped me. The sharp words, the gentle reprimands and the little corrections that I once found annoying were all expressions of love that I

had taken for granted. Now, silence fills those moments, and I find myself missing the words that once made me frown.

Her scolding was never meant to hurt. It was her way of guiding and protecting me and showing that she cared. Every correction was delivered with patience and concern, teaching me how to behave, how to respect others and how to navigate life. These lessons were subtle, wrapped in discipline, and it is only now that I can see how much wisdom they contained...I remember the times I argued with her, resisted her advice, or even ignored it. Yet even in my frustration, her intentions were pure.

She wanted what was best for me, even when I couldn't see it. Now that she has passed away, I realise that love does not always come wrapped in comfort. Sometimes it comes disguised as a warning, a correction or a rule designed to

protect…Her scolding taught me patience, both with her and with myself. It taught me resilience and the ability to listen, even when I didn't want to. It also taught me humility and the courage to accept guidance, even when it was uncomfortable. Now, whenever I face challenges, I can hear her voice in my mind, gently correcting me and reminding me of the difference between right and wrong. She is teaching me how to grow stronger.

Love often speaks in ways we do not immediately recognize. Discipline, guidance, and even tough words are forms of care. When someone teaches us with patience and firmness, it is a gift. And when they are gone, the true meaning of those lessons becomes clear. Cherish the guidance you receive, listen deeply, and carry it with gratitude—because it shapes the person you are meant to become.

Chapter 9

Small Moments, Heavy Memories

When Ordinary Things Begin to Hurt

After she had left, it wasn't the big memories that hurt the most; it was the small ones. The ordinary moments I had once ignored now carried a weight I had never expected. A cup of tea left untouched, a folded dupatta resting quietly, her favourite spot in the house – these simple things became reminders of all that I had lost.

I began to notice her absence in detail that had once felt unimportant. The way she remembered little things about everyone; the way she solved problems without being asked; the way her presence filled the room

without demanding attention. Now, even the quiet moments felt shaped by her absence, as if the house itself remembered her; Some memories arrived without warning. A familiar scent, a sound or a passing thought would suddenly pull me back. In those moments, it wasn't the memory itself that made my heart ache, but the beauty of it. I realised that grief often stems from deep, pure and real love.

There were days when I wished these memories would stop surfacing, just so the ache would ease. But over time, I came to understand that forgetting would hurt more. These moments were proof that she had played a full and active role in my life and that her love had permeated even the smallest aspects of my daily existence…slowly, I learned to embrace these memories instead of avoiding them. I allowed them to come and go, to hurt gently, and then to pass. They no longer felt like wounds, but rather like

reminders of a love that still exists, just in a different form.

Don't be afraid of the small moments that bring tears. They are not a sign of weakness, but a sign that the love mattered. Allow memories to come and go without resisting them. Hold them gently, learn from them and let them remind you that even the quietest love leaves the deepest mark on the heart.

Chapter 10

My First Achievement Without Her

Success Mixed with Absence

After my mother died, life did not slow down; it moved forward regardless of how I felt. The days passed, my responsibilities remained and people still had expectations of me, even though the person who had been my greatest support was no longer there.

A few months later, I received my results from Year 11. I had achieved 82%, and all my papers were clear. It was the exact achievement she had once wished for me. During my final years at school, she often prayed that I would score more than 80%. I still remember how she said it not as pressure, but as belief. She trusted me more than I trusted myself...When the results came in, there was no celebration at home. There were no happy tears, no gentle prayers whispered in gratitude and no quiet pride reflected in her eyes. Although I had fulfilled her wish, I felt an emptiness that no success

could fill. This was my first lesson in understanding that achievement does not always bring joy.

At the same time, I was embarking on another challenging yet meaningful journey: Hifz-e-Qur’an. She knew about it. She knew how much effort, patience and sacrifice it required. She knew how important it was to me. When my Hifz is completed in a few months, it will be one of the greatest achievements of my life. But she won't be there to see it, to hold my face and tell me she's proud. Now, I am writing my first book. This is another milestone, one that I had quietly dreamed of for a long time. I always had a simple wish: when I wrote my first book, whoever else was present or not, my mother should be there, silently supporting and being proud of me. However, that wish remained just that: a wish. Life did not give me that moment.

Today, I dedicate this book to her. Although she is not beside me, I feel her presence in every word I write. This book is my voice, but it is her strength that gives it power. Every page carries the love she poured into me, the patience she taught me and the courage she gave me, albeit unknowingly. Success after loss feels different. It is accompanied by silence instead of applause and by longing instead of celebration. You learn that happiness and pride can exist alongside pain and grief. These achievements do not erase the loss; they intensify it, but they also imbue it with meaning.

I have learned that achievements do not lose their value just because someone is absent. Some people come into our lives to inspire dreams, not to see them through to fruition. Fulfilling those dreams is not betrayal it is loyalty. It is a way of keeping their memory alive.

If you achieve something and the person you wanted to share it with is no longer around, don't let feelings of guilt consume you. Instead, carry your success with gratitude and humility. Let your growth be your tribute. Some mothers may not be there to celebrate their children's successes, but they will always be there to support them.

Chapter 11

Finding Purpose After Loss

Turning Pain into Direction

Loss not only takes a person away, but also the life we had imagined with them. After my mother died, I often asked myself: Now what?

What is the point of getting up every day when the person who gave my life meaning is no longer here?

For a long time, I believed that purpose would magically return over time. However, I learned that purpose is not found but built slowly and painfully from the pieces left behind.

At first, everything felt pointless. Dreams felt heavy, responsibilities felt unfair and hope felt distant. Yet somewhere between prayers, quiet tears and long nights of reflection, I realised that my pain itself was urging me to move forward, not to escape it but to embrace it..I realised that my purpose was no longer just about me. It was about becoming the kind of person my mother believed I could be. It was about continuing the journey she had prepared me for, even though she could no longer walk beside me.

I learned that loss does not destroy purpose; it reshapes it.

When you lose someone, you love, life presents you with two paths: one that keeps you trapped in the question “Why me?”, and another that asks, “What now?”

Choosing the second path does not mean forgetting the pain. It means allowing the pain to guide you instead of destroying you.

What Loss Taught Me About Purpose:

Accept the emptiness instead of fighting it. Purpose does not flourish in denial, but in acceptance. Feeling lost does not mean you are weak; it means you are human.

- Turn memory into motivation. Let the love you have received motivate you to work harder, not make you give up.
- Give your pain direction. Write, learn, teach, serve or create purpose grows

when pain is put to good use, not wasted.

- Stay connected to your faith. Loss can either push you away from Allah or draw you closer to Him. Your purpose will become clearer the more spiritually grounded your heart is.
- Keep growing, even when no one is watching. Some of your greatest victories will be silent. Don't wait for validation — your journey matters, even when you're alone.

I slowly stopped asking why my life had changed and started asking how I could still make it meaningful. I realised that purpose after loss is quieter, deeper and more sincere. It's not about achieving loud success; it's about inner strength.

My mother may no longer be here to guide me, but the values she instilled in me

continue to do so. Through loss, I did not lose my purpose I found an even stronger one.

Although loss will change your path, it does not have to end your journey. When you move forward intentionally, your pain can become your teacher, your memories your fuel, and your life a continuation of the love you once received.

Chapter 12

Learning to Live with an Empty Chair

When Absence Becomes a Part of Everyday Life

Living with loss is learning to live with its long shadow. In my life, that emptiness has a

memory. It sits in an empty chair. It waits. At first I only noticed it in silence, but later I saw it everywhere, when people conversed, when people celebrated and when I felt my greatest distress because I could not find comfort. They say that time heals all, but time past does not remove the chair. It simply teaches you how to sit around it. I learned that grief never leaves it settles.

At first, I thought I'd somehow ignore the emptiness, but you can only keep so busy before it settles in. But silence always returned, stronger than before. I have learned that healing does not equal filling the space left by the person who is gone. I think healing means you've accepted that not all spaces can be filled in. Love once filled mine. Love can't disappear. That empty chair will always be evidence of something that existed, and that I now have respect for, though I wish I could previously have resisted. Over time, the emptiness began to teach me patience. I

learned that strength does not always come across as loud or confident. Sometimes, strength is simply getting up and carrying on with life despite the pain. I stopped asking when the pain would end, and started asking how I could live with it gracefully. The empty chair no longer frightened me; it reminded me of the love, care and guidance that have shaped who I am today. I realised that absence does not erase connection; it transforms it into memory, and memory becomes a quiet companion.

Everyone carries an empty chair in some form loss, regret or unfulfilled dreams. Do not rush to fill it, and do not feel ashamed of it. Learn to live with it. Let it teach you empathy, patience and emotional resilience. Accept that some wounds never fully heal, yet they do not stop life from moving forward. When you make peace with absence, you become wiser, kinder, and stronger. Life does not ask us to forget what we have lost; it asks

us to honour it by moving forward with courage.

Feel the pain; don't fight it.

Grief has no deadline.

Hold on to your memories with respect, not guilt.

Move forward gently, not forcefully.

Absence may linger, but it does not dictate your future.

Chapter 13

Becoming Someone She Would Be Proud Of

Growing Through What Tried to Break Me

Losing my mother left a void in my life that could never be filled. Initially, I could not imagine moving forward, achieving anything or finding purpose. Every success felt incomplete and every smile was a reminder of her absence. I realised that grief would never fully leave me, but I also learned that life would not wait for me to catch up. I discovered that strength was not about avoiding pain; it was about learning to grow despite it.

I began to understand that becoming someone she would be proud of was not about perfection. Rather, it was about integrity, perseverance, and quiet courage. Every day, I made small choices that reflected the values she had instilled in me: patience, honesty, faith and kindness. Even when no one noticed, I worked on myself. Every accomplishment, no matter how small,

became a tribute to her love and belief in me...I found that growth is personal and deliberate. It requires using pain as a guide, not a restraint. I transformed my grief into purpose, using it to motivate me to study harder, write more sincerely and act with intention.

Instead of wishing she could witness every moment, I let her presence live within my actions, decisions and the strength I nurtured. Her guidance became internal, shaping the person I was becoming.

There were moments of doubt, when loneliness felt heavier than the loss itself. But I learned that life honours those who keep moving forward, even in silence. With each step I took, I made a statement: love does not end with absence; grief does not prevent growth; and dedication can transform pain into strength. I realised that my journey itself could become a living tribute to her.

If you have lost someone you love, let your life become a continuation of theirs. The most meaningful tribute you can offer is growth after loss.

Chapter 14

Carrying Her Forward

Transforming Grief into Purposeful Action

After learning to live with her absence and growing through my grief, I realised that life was calling me to achieve more than mere survival. My journey was no longer just my own — it was a continuation of her love, her teachings and her dreams. Every small effort and every step I took became a silent tribute to her. I started to see my pain not as a burden, but as fuel to motivate me to achieve,

create and inspire. I discovered that grief could transform into a guiding force if we allow it to.

I began to channel my emotions into meaningful actions. Writing my first book, completing my studies and pursuing Hifz became personal milestones that also honoured her presence in my life. I realised that carrying her forward meant taking responsibility for my own growth while holding on to her teachings. Even though she was not physically present, I knew that her values, prayers and belief in me could live on through my choices.

Transforming grief into purpose also taught me the importance of helping others. Every act of kindness, encouragement or guidance that I give to someone else reflects her love. I realised that pain shared through positive action creates more meaning. Loss does not have to be a burden; it can be a bridge

connecting the love we have lost with the lives we touch.

If you let it, grief can be your compass, guiding your actions. Don't wait for the perfect moment to honour those you have lost; honour them through your choices, your achievements and the values you live by. Carry their legacy forward in meaningful ways through courage, kindness and purpose. Although loss will always remain, your life can become a living tribute to the love that shaped you.

Chapter 15

A Last letter to My Mother

Words Left Unspoken, Love Forever Alive

Mother, I am writing these words knowing that you are not here to read them. Yet somehow, I feel as though you are listening. Every letter, every story and every page of this book represents a conversation that I never had the courage to have in person. I wish I could have handed them to you in person, seen your smile and heard your gentle voice say, 'I am proud of you.' But life did not give me that opportunity. Nevertheless, writing enables me to feel your presence, and to express what I could not say in the past. Your love remains the silent guide I follow every day.

I remember your hopes for me, the quiet wishes you held for my future. Though invisible now, your guidance shapes every choice I make. Every dream I pursue and every challenge I overcome carries your essence with it. Losing you was the most painful experience I have ever had, but it has also been my greatest teacher. I have learned that absence does not mean the end of influence. Your lessons live within me, silently moulding my courage, patience and compassion. I carry your love in my thoughts, letting it fuel every decision and every step I take.

Although you are not here to witness my achievements, I feel your presence in them. My studies, my writing, my journey through Hifz and now this book are all reflections of your belief in me. There are days when grief feels heavier than joy, but I have learned to live with it instead of letting it overwhelm me. I now understand that the love we hold for

someone never dies. It transforms into inner strength, guiding our choices and shaping our character, allowing us to honour their memory in tangible ways.

I want to tell everyone who has faced similar loss that absence does not erase love. Speak to your loved ones in your heart, continue the dreams they wished for you, and let your life become a living tribute. Grief will always accompany you, but it can coexist with growth, joy, and purpose. I carry you forward in everything I do, and in that act, you are never truly gone. Your teachings and dreams live on through me, becoming part of the lives I touch and the choices I make every day.

Mother, these words are my way of saying thank you, of promising that your love and wisdom continue to shape me. To anyone reading this, remember: absence cannot destroy love it transforms it. Carry it in your actions, in your dreams, and in your strength.

Let the memories of those you lost guide you, teach you, and inspire you. Live fully, love deeply, and grow with courage, for that is the most beautiful way to honour someone who shaped your life.

“Life will take away people you love, but it cannot take away the lessons, love, and memories they leave behind. Carry their values in your actions, their dreams in your choices, and their love in your heart. Let grief guide you, not break you. Live fully, grow patiently, and love deeply. Your life can become the most beautiful tribute to those you lost, and in doing so, you honour not just their memory, but the strength and hope they planted in you”

Thank you to every soul who held this book in their hands and carried these words in their heart.

If even a single page made you feel understood, then this book has fulfilled its purpose.

Remember this: life will test you, sometimes in silence, sometimes with pain you cannot explain. When depression surrounds you or worries feel too heavy to carry, **write them down**. Put your pain into words. When you write, your heart breathes and often, **half of your burden lightens** without you even realizing it.

You do not always need answers. Sometimes, you only need a pen, a page, and honesty with yourself. Healing begins there.

May you find strength in your softness, and peace in your truth.